

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Tariq Abbas

Address: 6 Grange Gardens Banstead SM7 3RF

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I support application DM2025/01591 as I would like to eventually use the facility as a place of worship and a place to develop community cohesion, tolerance and understanding.

Having looked at the development proposals, I am of the view that the proposal is scale appropriate, in keeping with the visual appearance of the area and an improvement compared to the existing classification of use.

The increased softscaping will improve the local streetscape and be welcome addition in terms of urban greening factor and biodiversity. As a Muslim myself, who is committed to strengthening community ties and having due high regard for neighbourly assistance and care in the community, I believe that our Muslim community can and will be a benefit to the area.

Our Muslim community is diverse and in need of a dedicated facility to serve local residents of the Muslim faith.

The Transport Statement highlights 269 street parking spaces in close proximity to the proposed site which has capacity at peak times for approximately 134 parking spaces, more than sufficient to meet the needs of the proposed development without being a burden on local parking needs.

In terms of noise, the proposed development as a place of worship and community hub, operating within defined hours to be agreed with the council, is confirmed by the noise report as an improvement compared to the current use as a 24-hour ambulance station.

The proposed use classification is for daytime and early evening use, rather than a 24-hour noise generating facility as is the current permitted type of use classification. Enabling local community educational classes, wellbeing classes, interfaith sessions so we can learn from each other, drop-ins and community events can only be a positive for Belmont.

In the comments, there is mention of a potential for conflict with the school run, however our prayer times do not clash with the morning / afternoon school drop off and pick up times and facility operators are aware to not conflict with school timings.

The environmental assessment documents have fully addressed Drainage and flood risk, energy conservation, biodiversity improvements and tree preservation.

As a son, and carer for my elderly mother, having a place of worship and community hub is important for both our health and wellbeing, sense of belonging in a tolerant and respectful society. The ability for both of us to enjoy community events within the facility would greatly improve are wellbeing.

Looking at comments associated with this application, and knowing existing worshippers of the God of Abraham, the God of Moses, the God of Noah, within the local area, there is a legitimate need for such a facility to address demand, increase community wellbeing and tolerance and alleviate overspill elsewhere. It is significant in this respect that the provision of additional community space in the Belmont would bring an increase in Social Value which must be taken into consideration, now more than ever given the rise in geopolitical tension and the fracturing of religious and racial harmony by some in our society.

I am of the view that this proposal is in keeping with planning policy, indeed it is a positive addition, benefiting the whole local area, not just Muslims.

I support this application as it meets all the relevant grounds for planning consent to be provided and therefore request the Council to grant planning permission.